



THE SELFIE REVOLUTION



Scan to review worksheet

Expemo code:

1GXG-61L2-CDF

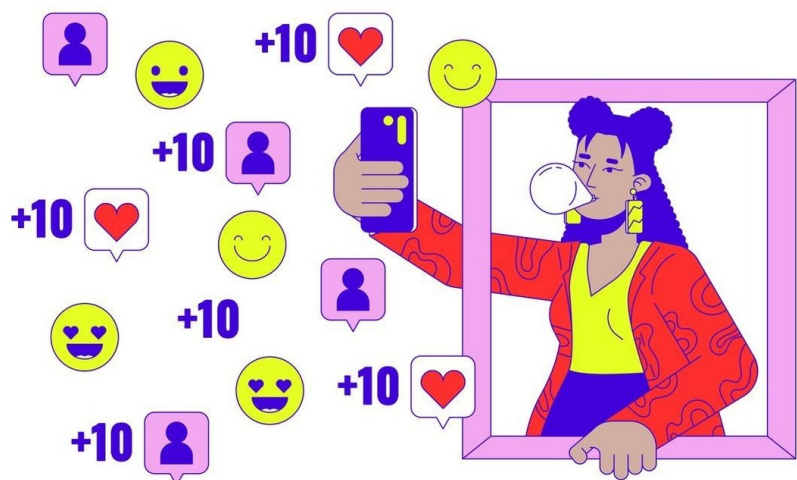


1

Warm up

In pairs, discuss the following questions.

1. Do you take selfies? Why or why not?
2. What do you think a selfie says about a person?
3. Do you think selfies are a good way to express yourself? Why or why not?
4. Have you ever taken a selfie in a funny or unusual place? Where?
5. Have you ever seen someone take a selfie in a strange or dangerous situation? What happened?





2

Key words

Complete the definitions with the correct words below.

airbrush

share

draw attention

terminally

make a fuss

vain

out of fashion

viral

1. If something goes _____, it is not popular anymore.
2. If somebody is _____, they are too proud of their appearance or abilities.
3. If you _____ a photo, you improve it with special equipment or computer software.
4. If something goes _____, it becomes extremely popular on the internet.
5. If a person is _____ ill, they have an illness that cannot be cured.
6. If you _____ about something, you show unnecessary excitement or interest in it.
7. If you _____ something on Facebook or Twitter, you let other people see, read or use it.
8. If you _____ to something, you focus on it.

3

Reading / listening comprehension

Part A: You are going to read or listen to an article titled "Selfies: a visual revolution?" about selfies. Find the information below in the text.

1. Who took a selfie that raised £3 million?
2. Which religious leader took selfies with fans?
3. When was the first selfie taken?
4. Where was the selfie taken?
5. What does it show?
6. Where was it shared?





Selfies: a visual revolution?

They are not just a vain trend. They are also a form of communication.

1. What to say about the selfie? Good or bad? Are they going out of fashion or are they a symbol of our vain times? And which to do? A no-make-up selfie? Gym selfie? Is it OK to airbrush? And what if, after all of that, nobody bothers to "like" it?
2. It seems that almost every week, a selfie is on the news. There's the thumbs-up selfie by a 19-year-old terminally ill patient, which went viral and raised £3 million. There were selfies taken by Pope Francis with fans at the Vatican. There was the first selfie from Space, and that Obama funeral selfie.
3. We have been making a fuss about the selfie recently, especially since the word entered our dictionaries. It is like we have discovered something new and brilliant. In fact, we have been taking selfies for most of the past century. For example, there's a photo that has been shared on Twitter. It shows five men on the roof of the Marceau Studio in New York, looking into the lens of an old analogue camera. It's possibly the world's first selfie. The date is December 1920.
4. "We didn't have a word for it until recently," says Jason Feifer, creator of the infamous 'Selfies at a Funeral' on the social networking site Tumblr. "And it is the word 'selfie', I think, which helped draw so much attention to them. Will we get bored of taking selfies? I doubt it. Selfies are a convenient way to document yourself. But I'm sure we'll get bored of talking about selfies, or treating them like they're new."
5. The fact is, we live in a world in which we all have camera phones. The new generation has grown up with them. Young people have created a new visual language which is understood by both sender and recipient. Communicating with this new visual language takes less time than writing long text messages.

Source: The Independent

Part B: Put true or false next to the statements below. Correct the statements which are false.

1. The writer thinks that selfies are something new. _____
2. The word 'selfie' has made people draw attention to selfies. _____
3. According to Jason Feifer, people will get bored of taking selfies. _____
4. According to Jason Feifer, people will get bored of talking about selfies. _____
5. It takes more time to communicate with selfies than with long text messages. _____



4

Scanning for vocabulary

Part A: Find the words and phrases from the text titled "Selfies: a visual revolution?" which mean the following.

1. _____ (v, para. 1): takes the time or trouble to do something
2. _____ (n, para. 2): a ceremony or service held shortly after a person's death
3. _____ (adj., para. 4): famous for a bad reason
4. _____ (adj., para. 4): easy to do/use
5. _____ (n, para. 5): someone who receives a message

Part B: Now complete the sentences below with the above words/phrases in the right form.

1. Tim didn't _____ to do his homework. He was too lazy.
2. My smartphone is very _____ — I can do so many things with it.
3. Jesse James was an _____ bank robber who lived in the United States in the 19th century.
4. The _____ of my email didn't get the message. There must be a problem with the email service.
5. Everybody came to Joanne's _____ to pay their respects.





5

Talking point

In pairs, discuss the following questions.

1. Do people talk about selfies in your country?
2. What do you think of this trend?
3. Do you think people are too vain nowadays?
4. Can you think of other modern trends? What do you think of them?

6

Language point (present perfect simple vs continuous)

Part A: Complete the rules below with: *present perfect* or *present perfect continuous*.

- We often use the _____¹ to talk about a recent event or a change that began in the past and is complete in the present.

It is like we have discovered something new and brilliant.

Young people have created a new visual language.

- We often use the _____² to talk about unfinished activities that started in the past and are still in progress in the present.

We have been making a fuss about the selfie recently.

- **Remember:** If we say 'when' something happened in the past (for example: *2 months ago, last year, yesterday, etc.*), we **CANNOT** use the present perfect tenses. We use a past tense.





Part B: Form sentences with the present perfect simple to describe the recent changes below. Make the sentences true.

1. communication / become / easier

2. English / stop / learning English

3. smartphones / make / our lives easier

4. technology / create / new trends

5. people / stop / watching television

6. global temperatures / increase / over the last 10 years

7. my English / improve

8. the transport system in my country / become / more efficient





Part C: Complete the sentences below with the verbs in the present perfect simple.

break**discover****finish****hear****open****receive****steal**

1. Scientists _____ a cure for cancer!
2. It's cold in here. _____ someone the window?
3. Look at Tom. It looks like he _____ his leg.
4. I can't find my wallet. I think someone _____ it.
5. At last! I _____ my homework!
6. _____ the news? Norman _____ a promotion.

Part D: Complete the sentences below with the present perfect continuous.

1. Julia is exhausted. She _____ hard for over 10 hours.
2. If you want to go outside, you'll need an umbrella. It _____ all morning.
3. People in my country _____ less money over the past few years because of the economic situation.
4. Scientists _____ a cure for cancer for centuries.
5. Joe is a teacher. He _____ since June.
6. They are almost at the end of the marathon. They _____ for over three hours.
7. Are you nearly here? I _____ for over 20 minutes!
8. It's nearly midday. How long _____ Dan _____ ?

7**Let's play!**

Take turns miming, drawing or describing situations (distributed by the teacher) where people might take selfies.



Transcripts

3. Reading / listening comprehension

Speaker: Selfies: a visual revolution?

Speaker: They are not just a vain trend. They are also a form of communication.

Speaker: What to say about the selfie? Good or bad? Are they going out of fashion or are they a symbol of our vain times? And which to do? A no-make-up selfie? Gym selfie? Is it OK to airbrush? And what if, after all of that, nobody bothers to "like" it?

Speaker: It seems that almost every week, a selfie is on the news. There's the thumbs-up selfie by a 19-year-old terminally ill patient, which went viral and raised £3 million. There were selfies taken by Pope Francis with fans at the Vatican. There was the first selfie from Space, and that Obama funeral selfie.

Speaker: We have been making a fuss about the selfie recently, especially since the word entered our dictionaries. It is like we have discovered something new and brilliant. In fact, we have been taking selfies for most of the past century. For example, there's a photo that has been shared on Twitter. It shows five men on the roof of the Marceau Studio in New York, looking into the lens of an old analogue camera. It's possibly the world's first selfie. The date is December 1920.

Speaker: "We didn't have a word for it until recently," says Jason Feifer, creator of the infamous 'Selfies at a Funeral' on the social networking site Tumblr. "And it is the word 'selfie', I think, which helped draw so much attention to them. Will we get bored of taking selfies? I doubt it. Selfies are a convenient way to document yourself. But I'm sure we'll get bored of talking about selfies, or treating them like they're new."

Speaker: The fact is, we live in a world in which we all have camera phones. The new generation has grown up with them. Young people have created a new visual language which is understood by both sender and recipient. Communicating with this new visual language takes less time than writing long text messages



Key

1. Warm up

5 mins.

These questions aim to engage students in discussions, connect with their personal experiences, and naturally introduce the grammar focus on the present perfect tense.

2. Key words

5 mins.

Students complete the definitions with the correct words.

- | | | | |
|-------------------|----------------|-------------|-------------------|
| 1. out of fashion | 2. vain | 3. airbrush | 4. viral |
| 5. terminally | 6. make a fuss | 7. share | 8. draw attention |

3. Reading / listening comprehension

Part A:

5 mins.

Students read the text and find the information in the text.

- | | |
|---|-----------------|
| 1. a 19-year old terminally ill patient | 2. Pope Francis |
| 3. December 1920 | 4. New York |
| 5. five men on the roof of the Marceau Studio | 6. on Twitter |

Source:

<https://www.independent.co.uk/tech/selfies-pioneers-of-a-visual-revolution-9353663.html>

Part B:

5 mins.

Students now put true or false next to the given statements. Ask them to correct the statements which are false.

1. False. [Selfies were taken in the past century.]
2. True. ["And it is the word 'selfie', I think, which helped draw so much attention to them."]
3. False. [They're a convenient way to document yourself.]
4. True. ["But I'm sure we'll get bored of talking about selfies, or treating them like they're new."]
5. False. [It takes less time.]

4. Scanning for vocabulary

Part A:

5 mins.

Students search for the words and phrases from the text to match the given definitions.

- | | | | | |
|------------|------------|-------------|---------------|--------------|
| 1. bothers | 2. funeral | 3. infamous | 4. convenient | 5. recipient |
|------------|------------|-------------|---------------|--------------|

**Part B:**

5 mins.

Now students use the words or phrases from Part A, to complete the given sentences. Circulate and help if necessary.

1. bother
2. convenient
3. infamous
4. recipient
5. funeral

5. Talking point

5 mins.

Students discuss the given questions in pairs or small groups.

6. Language point (present perfect simple vs continuous)**Part A:**

5 mins.

Students complete the rules with either present perfect or present perfect continuous. You might ask them to look at the examples to guide them.

1. present perfect
2. present perfect continuous

Part B:

5 mins.

Students form sentences with the present perfect simple to describe the recent changes. They should make the sentences true.

1. Communication has become easier
2. People haven't stopped learning English
3. Smartphones have made our lives easier
4. Technology has created new trends
5. People haven't stopped watching television.
6. Global temperatures have increased over the last 10 years.
7. My English has/hasn't improved.
8. The transport system in my country has/hasn't become more efficient.

Part C:

5 mins.

Students complete the sentences with the given verbs in the present perfect simple.

- | | | |
|--------------------|-----------------------|----------------------------------|
| 1. have discovered | 2. Has someone opened | 3. has broken |
| 4. has stolen | 5. have finished | 6. Have you heard ? has received |

Part D:

5 mins.

Now students complete the sentences with the present perfect continuous.

- | | |
|-----------------------|--------------------------|
| 1. has been working | 2. has been raining |
| 3. have been spending | 4. have been looking for |
| 5. has been teaching | 6. have been running |
| 7. have been waiting | 8. has ? been sleeping |



7. Let's play!

15 mins.

Students take turns miming, drawing or describing situations where people might take selfies (e.g., at a birthday party, in front of a famous monument, during a workout), and their teammates guess the situation. After guessing, teammates ask follow-up questions using the present perfect (e.g., "Have you ever taken a selfie there?").

<i>at a birthday party</i>	<i>in front of a landmark</i>	<i>at the gym</i>
<i>at a concert</i>	<i>with a pet</i>	<i>at a fancy restaurant</i>
<i>in the mirror</i>	<i>on a beach</i>	<i>in the rain</i>
<i>climbing the mountain</i>	<i>wearing a funny costume</i>	<i>in front of the car</i>
<i>at a wedding</i>	<i>with a group of friends</i>	<i>at dangerous place</i>
<i>on an airplane</i>	<i>using funny filter</i>	<i>during a snowy day</i>